

Can someone explain how crypto and AI are bad for the environment?

Posted by u/gracemmvi • 0 points • 9 comments

I've seen a few posts about how crypto mining and creating AI content impacts the environment but I don't really understand what resources it is using or how it does it. Can someone help? I've seen a video with 'crypto mining' and it included a lot of water but I just don't understand it at all

Comments

u/Commercial-Study4498 • 0 points • 2025-02-27 21:47 UTC

[<https://app.spaios.com/#/pages/login/login?invitationCode=4210582997>]
(<https://app.spaios.com/#/pages/login/login?invitationCode=4210582997>)

this is the best ai crypto

u/lreeb • 1 points • 2025-02-27 09:25 UTC

They use lots and lots of compute power, which uses lots and lots of electrical power. Manufacturing the hardware also takes up a lot of resources, including water.

u/Sharzzy_ • 1 points • 2025-02-27 02:49 UTC

Mining uses a lot of data/electricity

u/formthemitten • 1 points • 2025-02-27 02:19 UTC

Mining crypto, and operating ai take A LOT of energy. Warehouse that keep these servers and mass crypto farms are literally just giant ventilation systems with computers inside of them.

Energy consumption is objectively bad for the environment, so when it's happening for such a useless cause (crypto is 100% useless, ai you could argue) it causes controversy

u/RecentSugar5696 • 0 points • 2025-02-27 02:16 UTC

AI porn is different

u/Luminaria19 • 2 points • 2025-02-27 01:35 UTC

The short version is that they use very powerful computers. These powerful computers require a lot of electricity. In most places, that electricity is being provided by polluting sources (e.g. coal, gas). In some instances, the power draw is so high that places are needing to increase power production in order to support the computers alongside their "normal" power uses (e.g. people's homes and "regular"

businesses).

These computer farms often also require a lot of cooling to remain functional, but that tends to just add onto "they use a lot of electricity."

u/rhomboidus • 6 points • 2025-02-27 01:34 UTC

Crypto mining is basically just having a computer do complicated math for a long time until it solves an equation that gives it a tiny bit of crypto. That eats up a crazy amount of electricity.

"AI" (really LLMs and similar models) also are incredibly inefficient. Asking Chat GPT how to make soup consumes a ridiculous amount of electricity because the way these models work is kind of nuts.

u/shootYrTv • 3 points • 2025-02-27 01:34 UTC

These processes both take massive warehouses full of computers running hot 24/7. They need massive amounts of water to cool them. It's far, far more resources to accomplish far less than other computer hardware and server requirements.

u/bmiller201 • 4 points • 2025-02-27 01:32 UTC

It takes a ton of energy to do both. AI doesn't really take much more than a search engine unless the training takes a lot of power. But crypto mining takes a lot of energy and a lot of cooling to do.